

# ***PACKAGING UPDATE***

**Presented at:**  
***2026 Popcorn Board Meeting***  
***March 10, 2026***

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# Cryovac Retort Lab & Food Packaging Lab

Thermal Processing  
Flexible Packaging  
Research  
Process/Package  
Development  
Flexible Package  
Integrity/Evaluation  
Shelf-Life Testing  
Industry Training



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# Food Packaging Trends

- Sustainability
  - Many descriptions:
    - Recycle Illusion
      - Recyclable vs Recycled
      - Recycling Fatigue
    - Cost
- Cleaner Label
  - Food & Packaging
- Trust
  - Food & Packaging
- Continued Automation

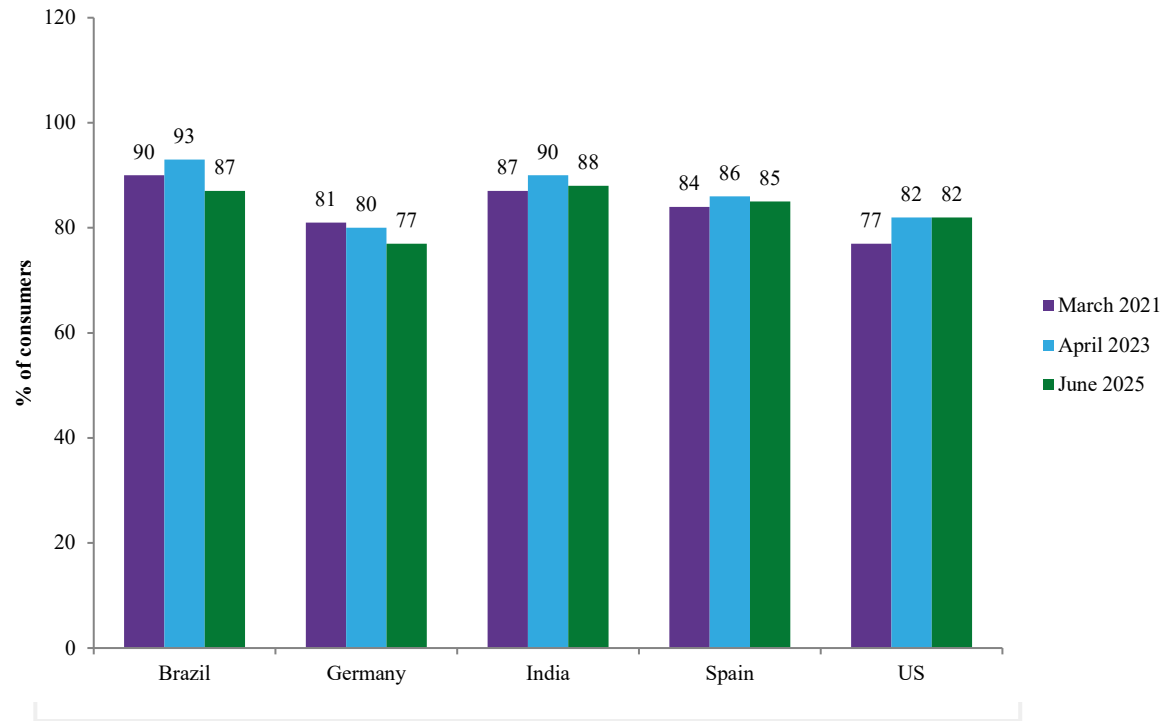




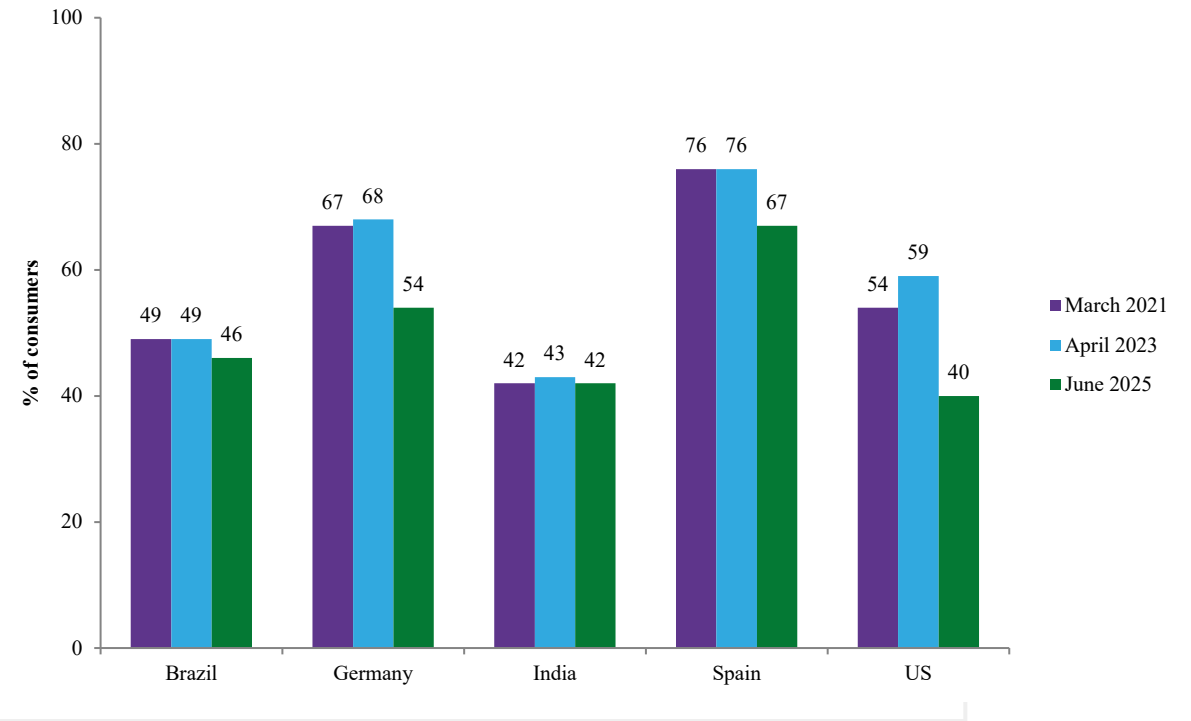


# Consumers want to align their actions with their genuine concern for the environment

Select global markets: agreement with “I try to act in a way that is not harmful to the environment”, 2021-25



Select global markets: consumers who have recycled packaging in the past 12 months, 2021-25



Base: 2021 - India, US: 500 internet users aged 18+ in each market; Brazil, Germany, Spain: 500 internet users aged 16+ in each market; 2023 and 2025 - India, US: 1,000 internet users aged 18+ in each market; Brazil, Germany, Spain: 1,000 internet users aged 16+ in each market

Source: Mintel, [March 2021](#), [April 2023](#), June 2025

[Read on mintel.com](https://www.mintel.com)

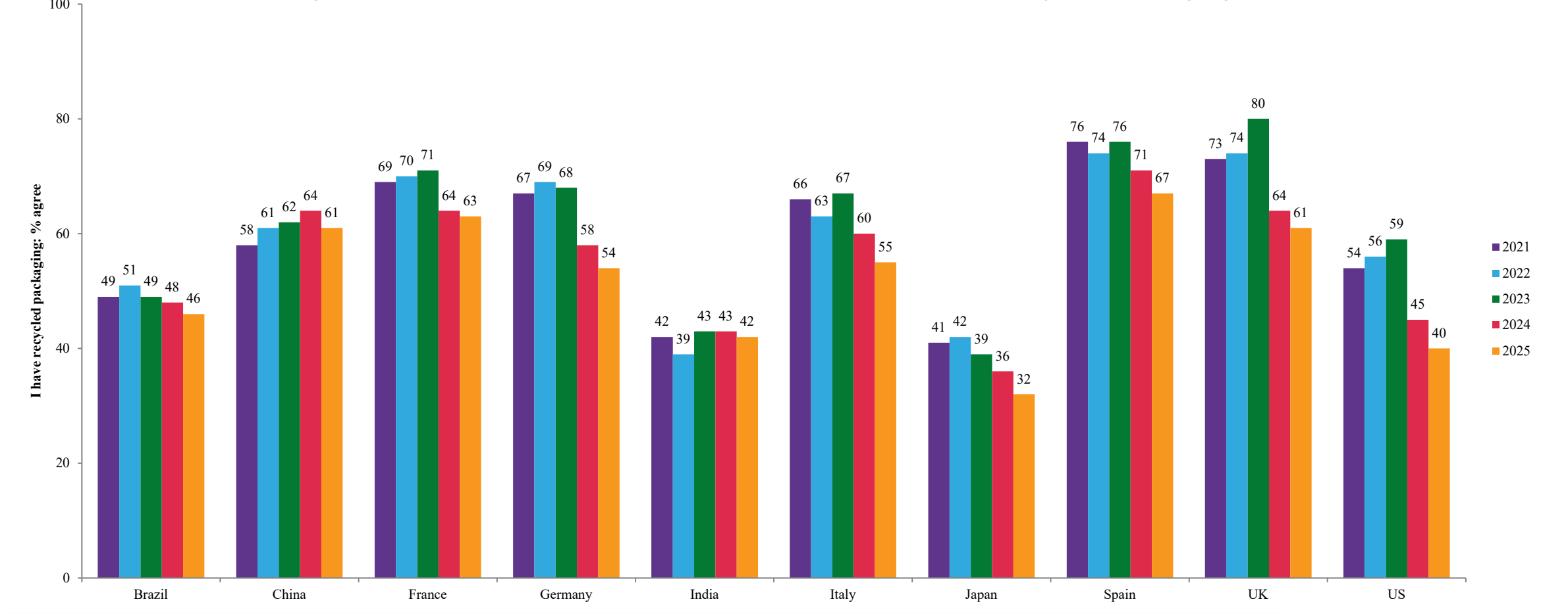


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# Recycling fatigue: people are recycling less as trust in the system breaks down

Select global markets: sustainable activities over the last month – recycled packaging, 2021-25

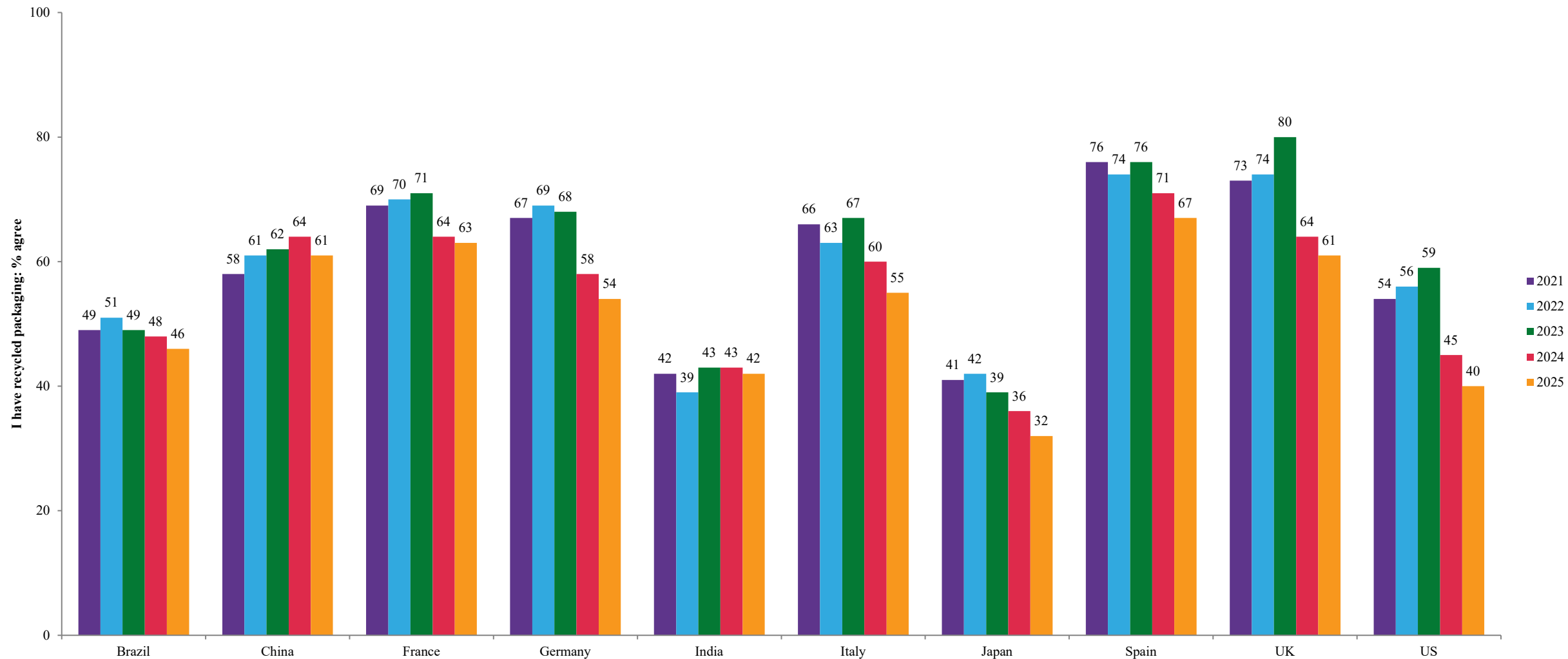


Base: 2021 - China, India, Japan, US: 500 internet users aged 18+ in each market; Brazil, France, Germany, Italy, Spain, UK: 500 internet users aged 16+ in each market; 2022-25 - China, India, Japan, US: 1,000 internet users aged 18+ in each market; Brazil, France, Germany, Italy, Spain, UK: 1,000 internet users aged 16+ in each market

Source: Mintel, [March 2021](#), [April 2022](#), [April 2023](#), [June 2024](#), June 2025

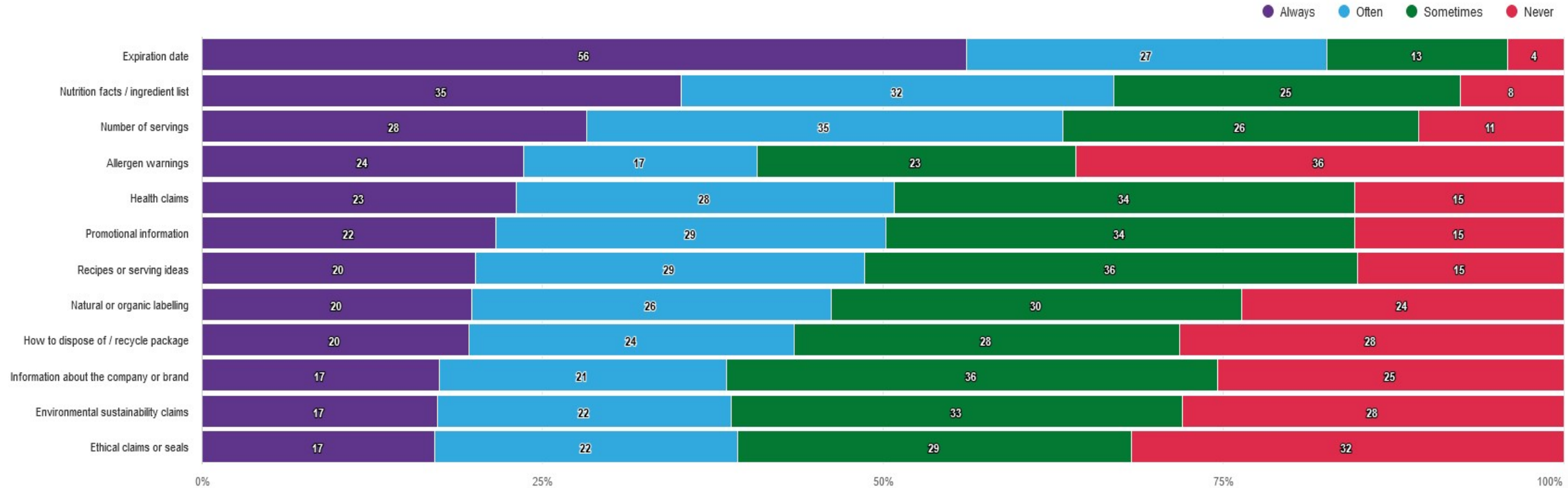
# Global Consumer Perceptions on Recycling

Select global markets: sustainable activities over the last month – recycled packaging, 2021-25



Base: 2021 - China, India, Japan, US: 500 internet users aged 18+ in each market; Brazil, France, Germany, Italy, Spain, UK: 500 internet users aged 16+ in each market; 2022-25 - China, India, Japan, US: 1,000 internet users aged 18+ in each market; Brazil, France, Germany, Italy, Spain, UK: 1,000 internet users aged 16+ in each marketSource: Mintel, [March 2021](#), [April 2022](#), [April 2023](#), [June 2024](#), June 2025

# Important Information on Packaging







# Packaging is becoming an interactive touchpoint; leverage QR codes on packaging to deepen engagement and build trust

Smart packaging, including QR codes, appeals to consumers, [especially younger ones](#), who want to learn more about a product's sustainability, ethical sourcing and company background.

QR codes are an effective way to provide this extra information without cluttering the package. Brands can use them to share product stories, interactive content and educational material about recycling and sustainability. This helps fill knowledge gaps and boosts confidence in consumers, particularly for those who want to make eco-friendly choices but are unsure how.

ENGAGEMENT WITH QR CODES IS  
GROWING

50%

of [consumers are likely to scan a QR code](#) to learn more about a product

*Base: 1,971 internet users aged 18+ who are responsible for food/beverage shopping*

*Source: Mintel, May 2025*



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*Read on [mintel.com](https://www.mintel.com)*



# Consumer Fast Facts

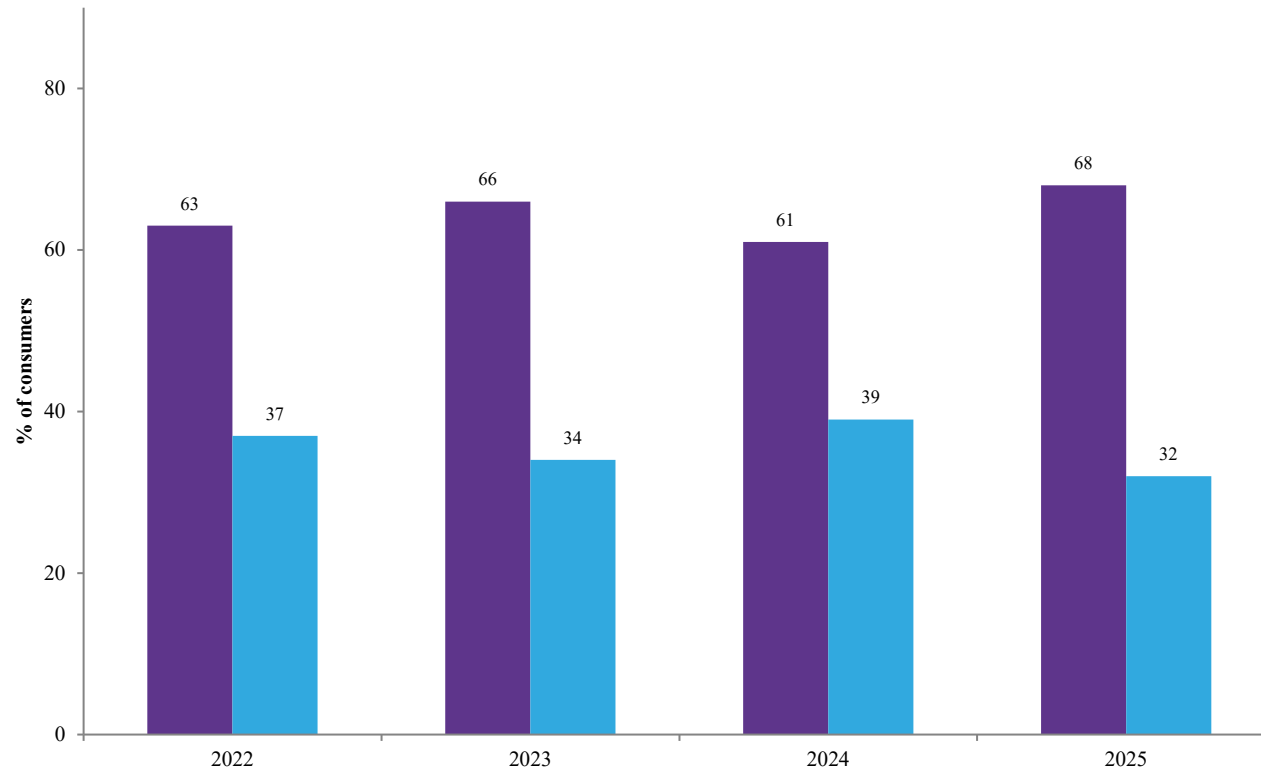
- Higher cost of living drives a greater focus on price over sustainability in 2025
- Consumers place the greatest responsibility for environmentally friendly food and drink choices on manufacturers and packaging producers, and food retailers are seen as gatekeepers
- Purchase decisions based on product labels are driven by the basics, such as expiration dates and nutritional information; sustainability is an emerging tie-breaker
- Sustainability matters, but only when it doesn't raise costs; just over half of consumers now believe it is more important for companies to keep costs low than to invest in sustainable packaging
- Plastic is viewed negatively, with packaging being seen as a signal of sustainability and safety
- Sustainable packaging is a baseline expectation, especially for everyday purchases like groceries



# Rising costs push a greater focus on price over sustainability in 2025

## US: importance of price vs sustainability in food/drink purchases, 2025

- Price is more important than sustainability/environmental claims
- Sustainability/environmental claims are more important than price



The economic outlook remains uncertain as rising prices and tariff uncertainty continue to weigh on consumer confidence. In response, consumers are adopting a cautious approach to spending, prioritizing value and savings.

While consumers have consistently placed price above sustainability in past years, the emphasis on cost has intensified in 2025. This shift is particularly evident in attitudes toward food packaging: just over half of consumers now believe it is more important for companies to keep costs low than to invest in sustainable packaging.

*Base: 2025: 1,971 internet users aged 18+ who are responsible for food/beverage shopping; 2024: 1,976 internet users aged 18+ who are responsible for food/beverage shopping; 2023: 1,952 internet users aged 18+ who are responsible for food/beverage shopping; 2022: 1,932 internet users aged 18+ who are responsible for food/beverage shopping*

*Source: Mintel, May 2025, June 2024, May 2023, March 2022*



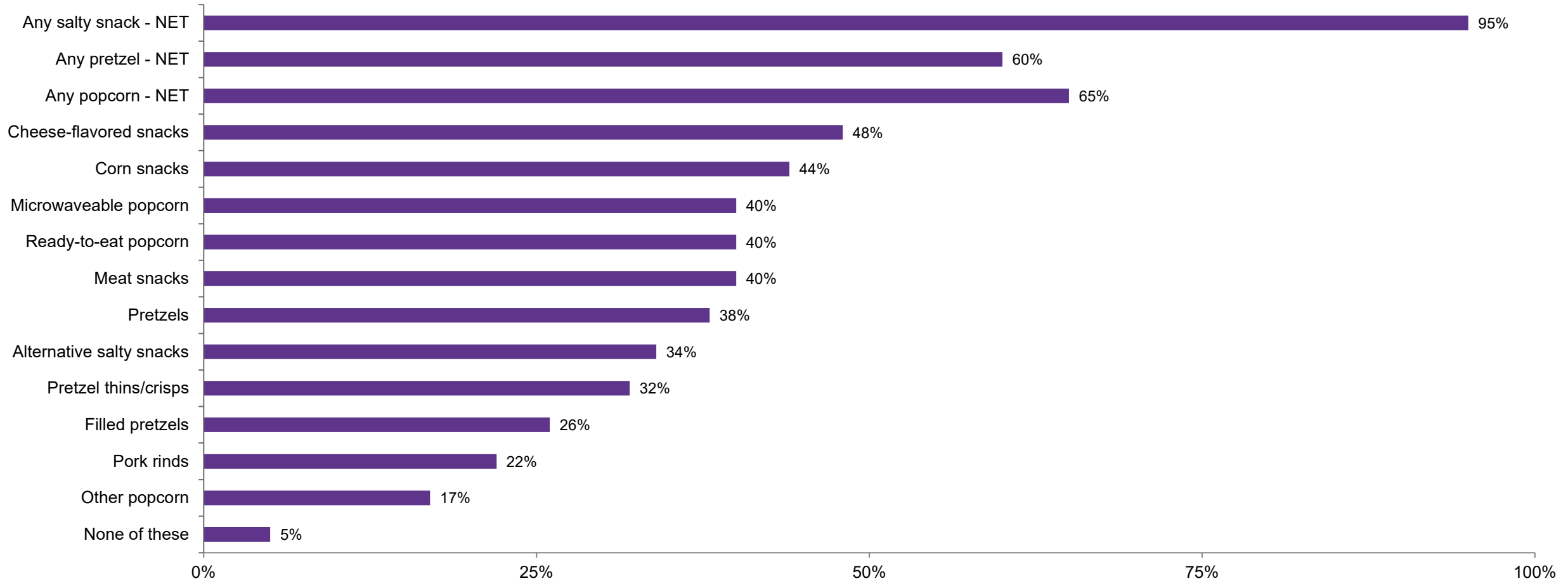
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*Read on [mintel.com](https://www.mintel.com)*



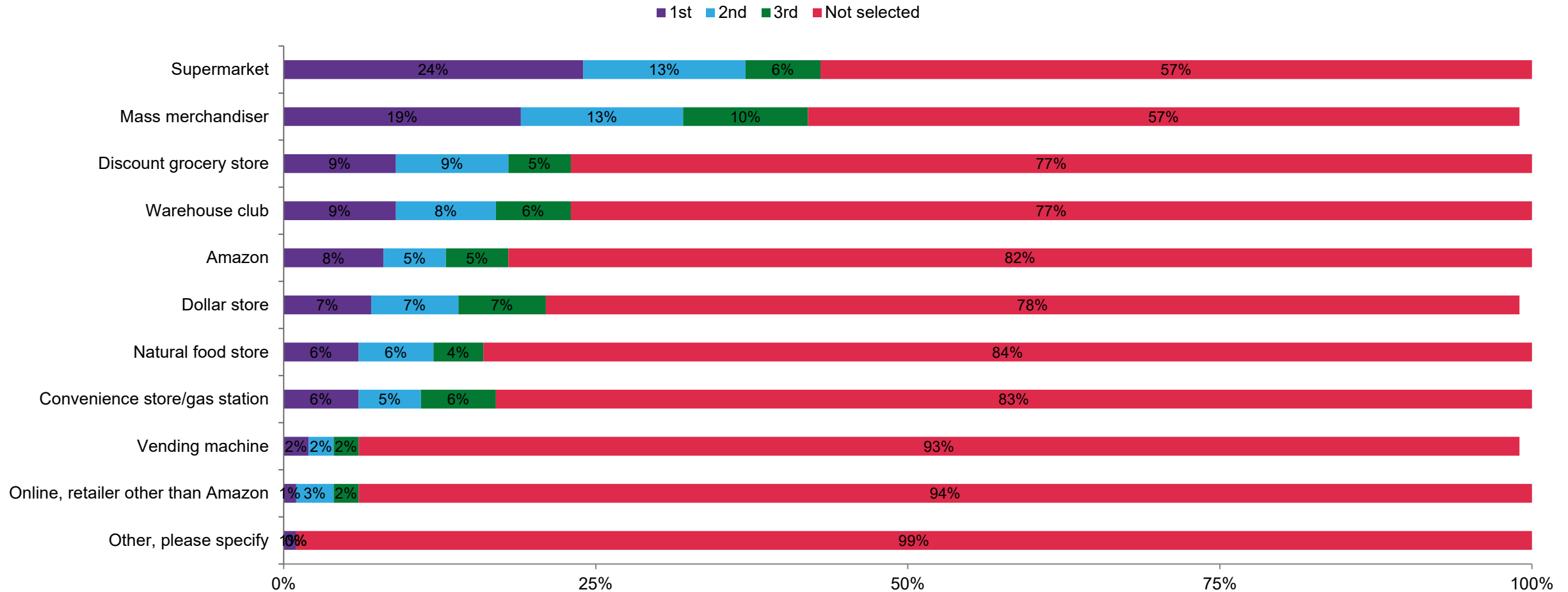
# Which of the following salty snacks have you eaten in the past 3 months?

## Please select all that apply. (NET)



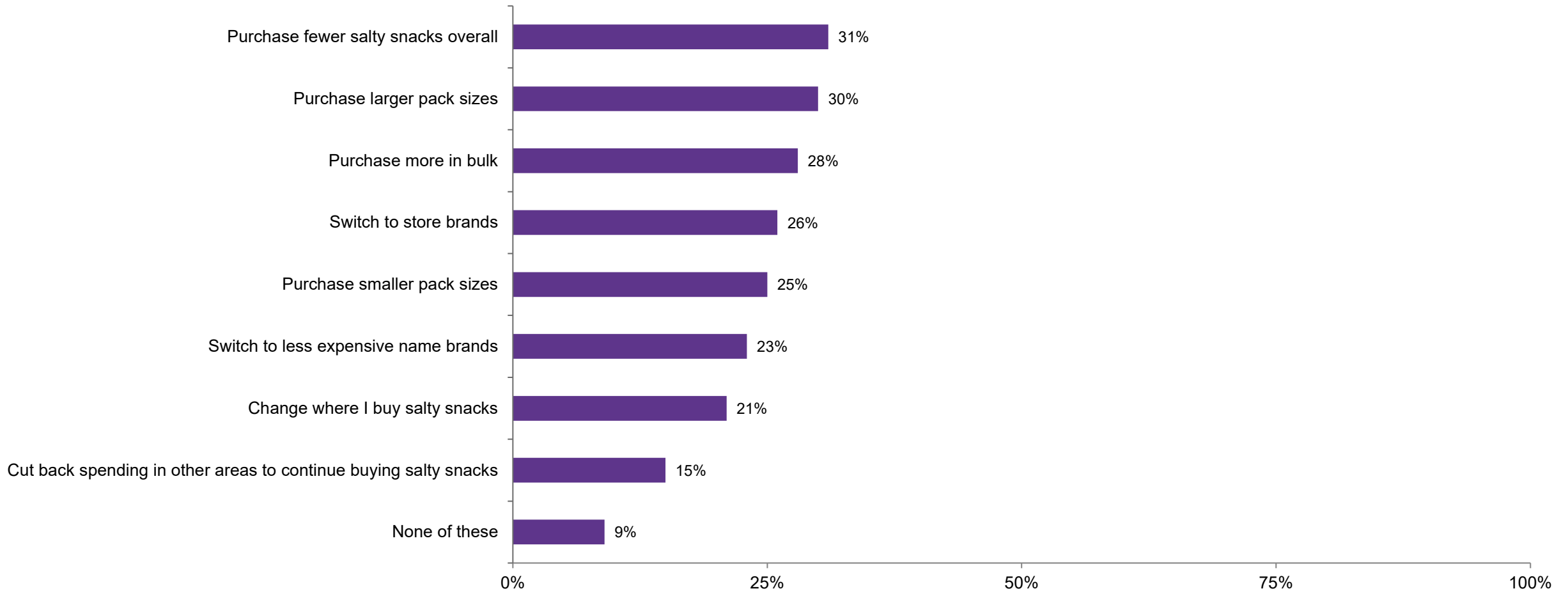
Base: 1,970 internet users aged 18+ who snack

# Where do you purchase salty snacks, potato chips, or tortilla chips most often?



Base: 1,950 internet users aged 18+ who have eaten any salty snacks, potato chips or tortilla chips in the last three months

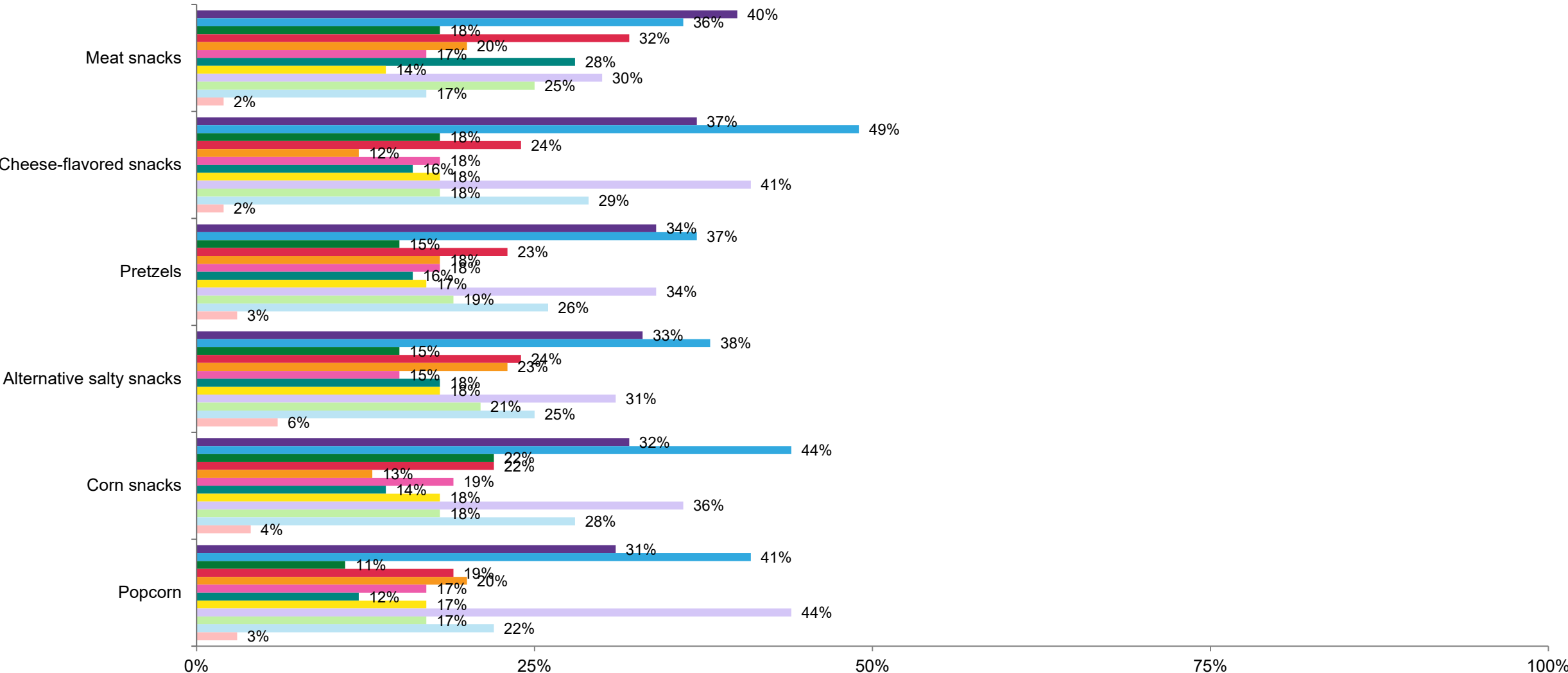
# If the price of salty snacks increases, which of the following would you consider to help manage costs?



Base: 1,716 internet users aged 18+ who ate salty snacks in the past three months and purchased salty snacks/potato chips/tortilla chips

# Why do you eat each of the following types of salty snacks?

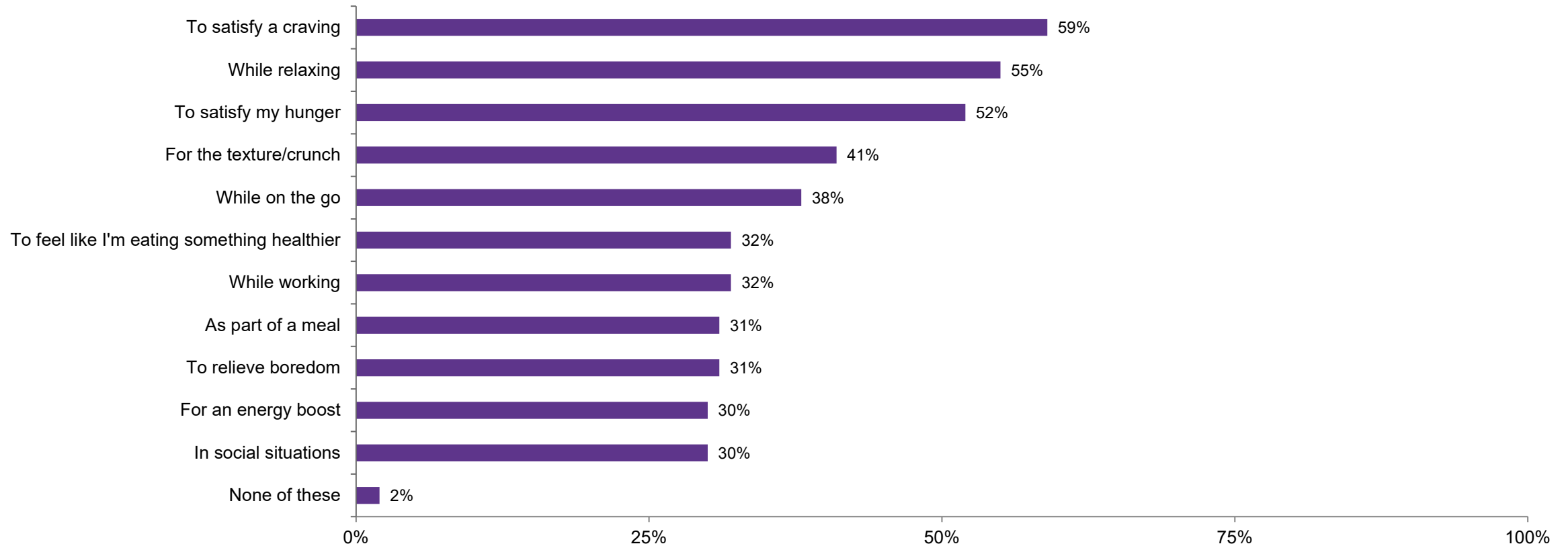
- To satisfy my hunger
- To satisfy a craving
- As part of a meal
- While on the go
- To feel like I'm eating s...
- To relieve boredom
- For an energy boost
- In social situations
- While relaxing
- While working
- For the texture/crunch
- None of these



Base: internet users aged 18+ who have eaten specific salty snacks in the last three months

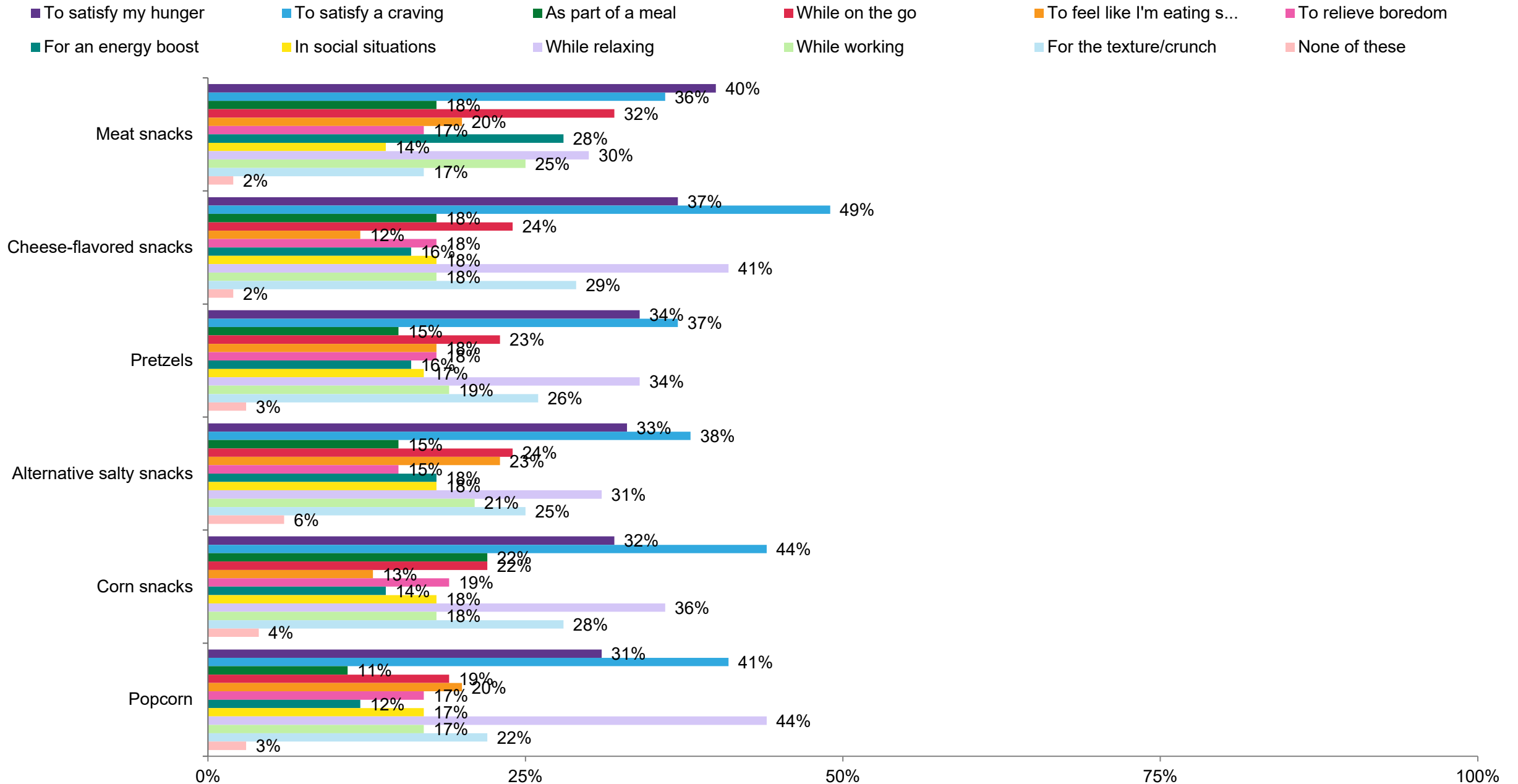


## Why do you eat each of the following types of salty snacks?



Base: 1,850 internet users aged 18+ who have eaten specific salty snacks in the last three months

# Why do you eat each of the following types of salty snacks?



# When choosing each of the following types of salty snacks, which of the following factors are important?

- Price/cost

Familiar brand

Texture

Made with all natural ing...

Minimally processed

Familiar flavor or variet...
- New flavor or variety

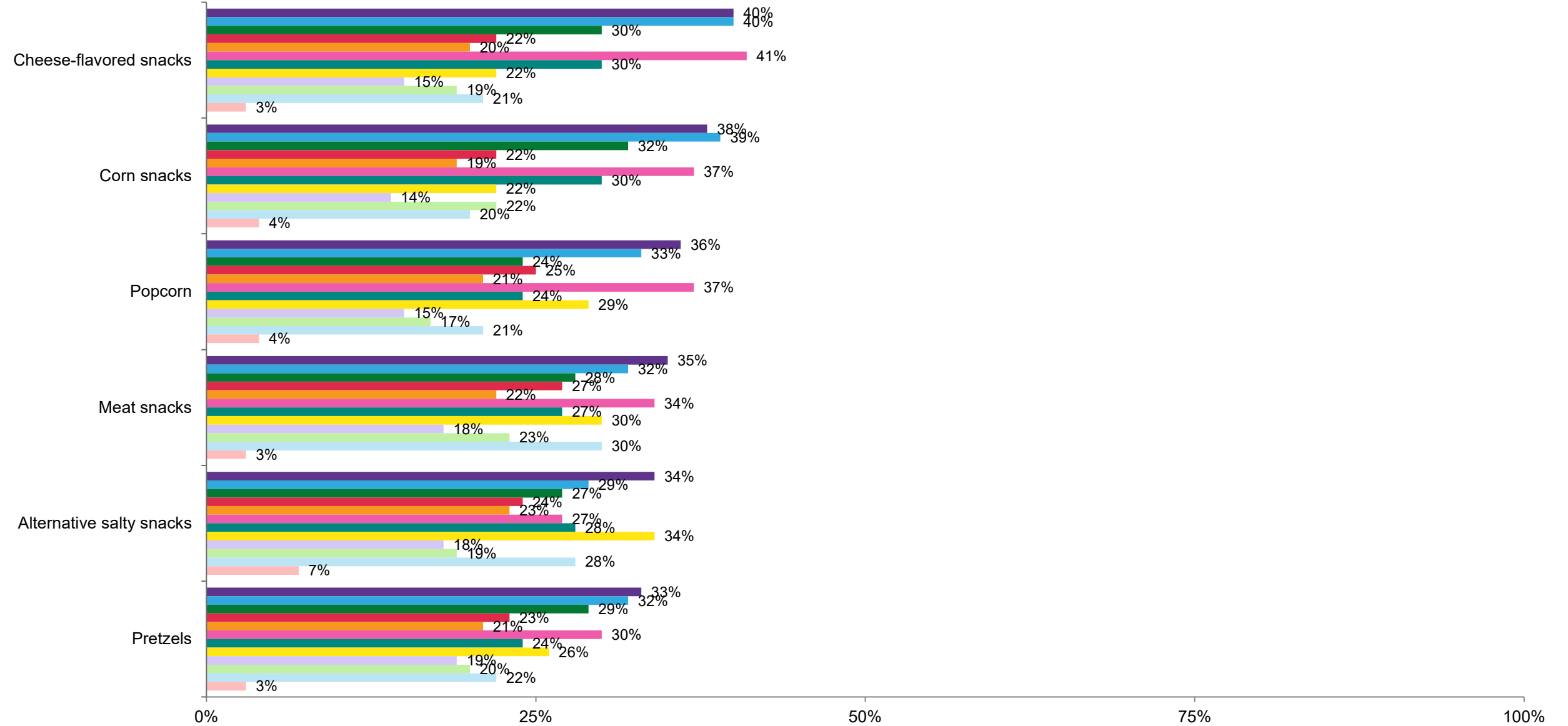
Healthful

Sustainably sources

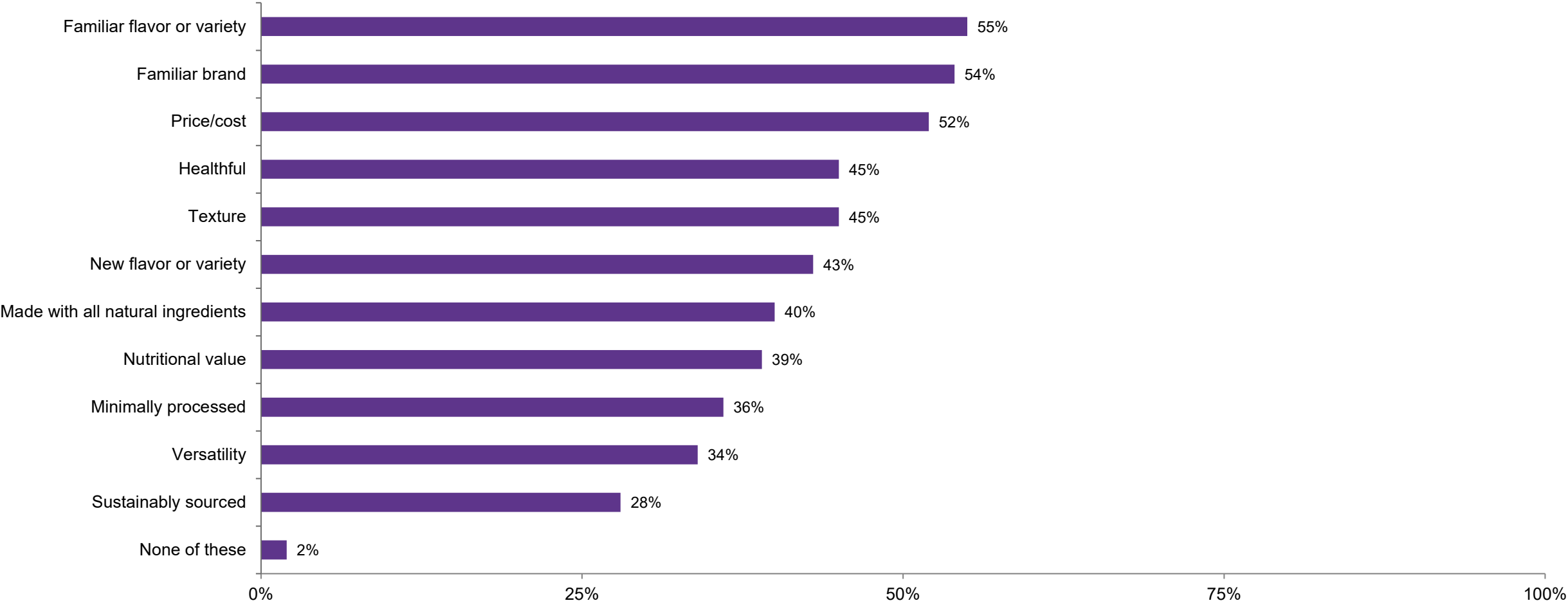
Versatility

Nutritional value

None of these



# When choosing each of the following types of salty snacks, which of the following factors are important?



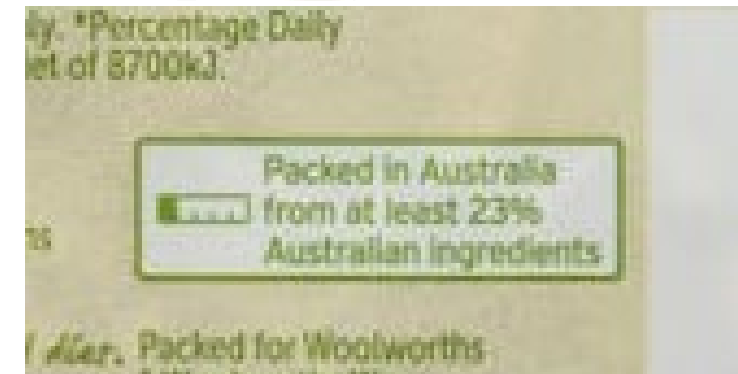
Base: 1,706 internet users aged 18+ who have eaten specific salty snacks in the last three months and purchased salty snacks/potato chips/tortilla chips

- **Product**

- New Zealand
- Woolworth's
- Macro Wholefoods Market Snack Mix

- **Claims:**

- 5 Star Health Rating
- 25% Australian Ingredients



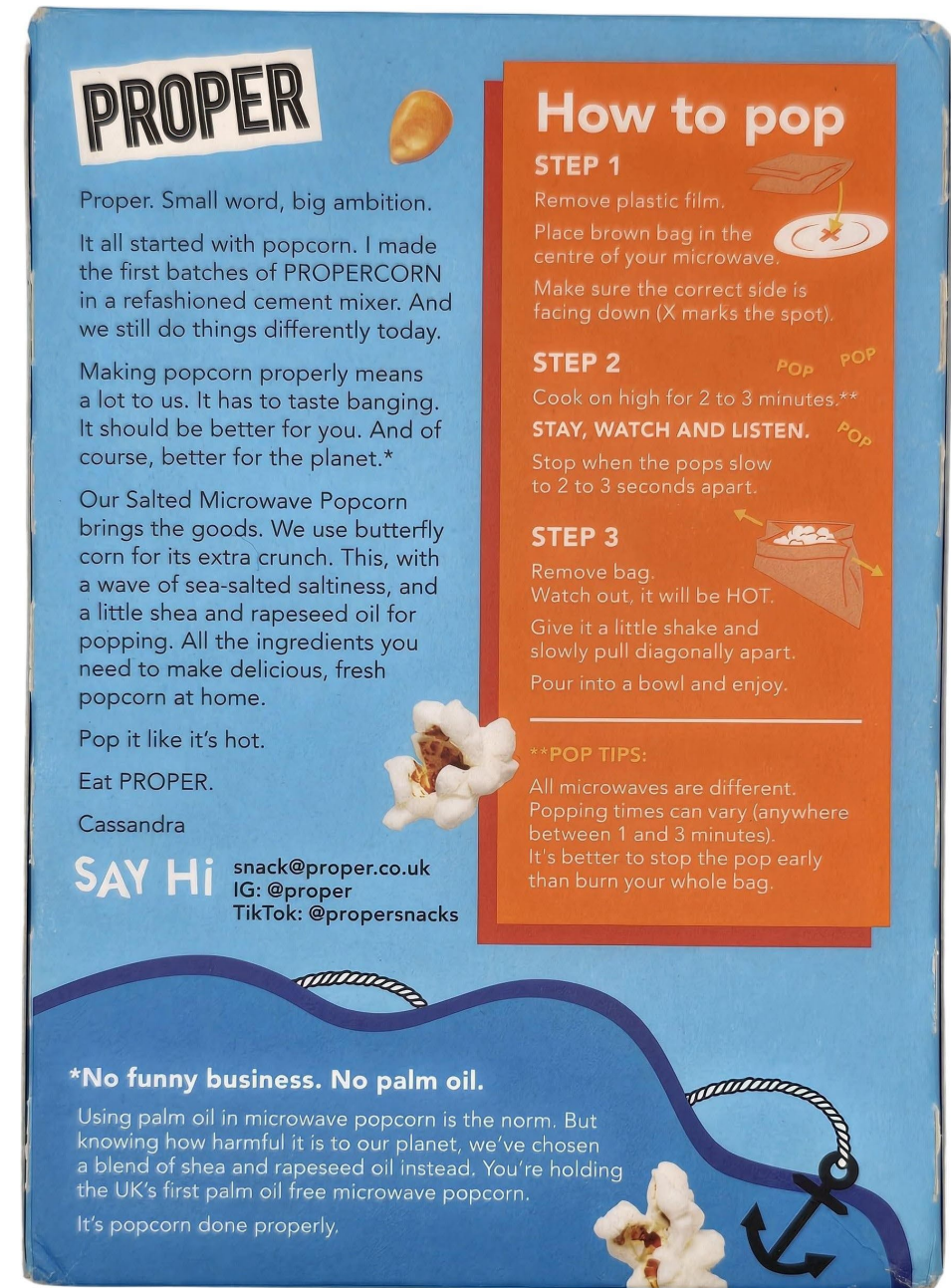


- **Product**
  - Popcorn Gourmet Franquia, Brazil
  - Brand PopCorn Gourmet
- **Claims:**
  - Exclusive recipe





- **Product**
- **Proper, UK**
- **Propercorn Brand**
- **Claims:**
  - New
  - "Refashioned cement mixer"



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- **Product**
  - **Rossi Rei – Kenya**
  - **Reis Snackk-eez**
- **Claims:**
  - Product of Kenya
  - Recycling



PLEASE RETURN ME TO MY SHOP/STORE FOR RECYCLING  
 This bag is Produced / Printed by: Bobmil Industries Ltd  
 PO. Box 48876 - 00100, Nairobi - Kenya



- **Product**
  - **Topcorn, Switzerland**
  - **Top Corn Brand**
- **Claims:**
  - **Grown in Switzerland**





- **Product**
  - *Jacc4our, Malaysia*
  - *myEureka Brand*
- **Claims:**
  - New Flavors



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- **Product**
  - Zhongbai Warehouse Supermarket
  - China
  - Goo Brand
- **Claims:**
  - New







**Questions?**

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